A large number of cross-platform database options are available, including the free and very popular MySQL. However, I selected the file-based SQLite database system for readers who want to develop on a non-Windows environment simply from the ease-of-use point of view. It is already installed on most versions of Linux and macOS. Having said that, there is no reason why you can't use SQLite if you are developing on Windows. It's a pretty good choice for smaller sites. It is deployed along with the rest of the application files, potentially simplifying deployment and reducing your hosting costs. In terms of managing an SQLite database, I use the free DB Browser for SQLite, which is cross-platform and available at https://sqlitebrowser.org/.

Whichever database system you choose to go with, you should now be ready to move forward with developing Razor Pages applications. You understand the role of Razor Pages in the web development diaspora and the key features that make it a great choice. It is modern and fast and doesn't get in the way of the development process. In the next chapter, you will waste no time producing your first working Razor Pages application and learning the fundamentals of building more complex applications.

Summary

- Razor Pages is a page-focused framework for developing dynamic web applications.
- Razor Pages is a Microsoft technology.
- Razor Pages is part of ASP.NET Core, which, in turn, is part of .NET 6.
- Razor Pages is cross-platform.
- Razor Pages is open source and free.